```
    [1]=>
    &object(person)(1) {
      ["name"]=>
      string(6) "Barney"
    }
}
```

$fred is a copy of the object that the constructor stored in $people[0], while $barney is an alias for the object that the constructor stored in $people[1]. When we change the properties of $fred, we're not changing the object that is in $people[0]. However, when we change the properties of $barney, we are changing the object in $people[1].

To prevent copying on assignment, assign by reference:

```
$obj =& new Class;
```

This code makes $obj an alias for the new object, which was $this in the constructor. If the constructor stores a reference to $this, it keeps a reference to $obj.

The documentation for a class should say whether you need to use =& with its constructor. In most cases, this isn't necessary.